IFEANYI FORTUNE DABERECHI

AI & Cybersecurity Researcher | Graduate Teaching & Research Assistant

TELEVISION, KADUNA STATE, NIGERIA

+2349027155093, +2349066299003 | ifeanyi.d.fortune@gmail.com

Portfolio | Google Scholar | ORCID | Semantic Scholar

OBJECTIVES AND SUMMARY

First Class Cyber Security graduate (CGPA: 4.89/5.00) and Graduate Research and Teaching Assistant at the Air Force Institute of Technology (AFIT), Nigeria. My research experience centers on artificial intelligence and machine learning, with applications in cybersecurity, intelligent threat detection, natural language processing, large language models, computer vision, and privacy-preserving AI. I have contributed to 15 research manuscripts involving machine learning for zero-day attack detection, IoT security, phishing detection, LLM-assisted cybersecurity, and privacy-aware intelligent systems. I am seeking a PhD in Computer Science to deepen my expertise in machine learning, deep learning, NLP, computer vision, and intelligent systems, while applying these methods to complex real-world problems in cybersecurity and beyond.

EDUCATIONAL HISTORY

- **Air Force Institute of Technology, Kaduna, Nigeria | www.afit.edu.ng/** **April 2021–October 2024**

  Bachelor of Science in Cyber Security

  Major GPA: 5.0/5.0 **Cumulative GPA: 4.89/5.00** **Top 1%** **First Class Honours**

RESEARCH/TEACHING EXPERIENCE

GRADUATE RESEARCH & TEACHING ASSISTANT **JANUARY 2025 – PRESENT**

Air Force Institute of Technology (AFIT), Kaduna, Nigeria

- Conduct research within the Department of Cyber Security, contributing to **AI-driven cybersecurity**, with emphasis on intelligent threat detection, machine learning, federated learning, IoT security, web application security, and cyber defence.
- Design and evaluate machine learning and deep learning models for **network intrusion, IoT threats, phishing, deepfake, and malicious traffic detection**, using Random Forest, CNN, LSTM, and Federated Learning.
- Contributed to **15 research manuscripts**, including 8 published journal articles, 2 conference papers, 2 accepted papers, and 3 under review, with first-author contributions to AI/ML-based cyber threat detection research.
- Conducted comprehensive literature reviews, experimental evaluations, comparative analyses, feature analysis, and statistical performance assessment for cybersecurity research.
- Contributed to research involving **Large Language Models for cybersecurity**, including LLM-assisted threat-driven testing and real-time data anonymisation.
- Conduct research involving **privacy-preserving and federated AI**, including IoT threat detection and differential privacy for robust defence against data poisoning.
- Mentor undergraduate researchers in research methodology, experimental design, literature review, and scientific writing.
- Contributed to expanding research activities within the department through collaborative projects involving faculty members and student researchers.
- Presented research findings during departmental seminars and academic discussions, fostering knowledge sharing and collaborative research culture.
- Facilitate tutorials and practical laboratory sessions in Computer Networking, Ethical Hacking, Machine Learning, Cloud Computing, Data Structures, and Algorithms, supporting practical training for 180+ undergraduate students.

- Assisted in integrating practical cybersecurity simulations and AI-based security exercises into undergraduate coursework.
- Deliver hands-on cybersecurity training using Burp Suite, Wireshark, Nmap, Metasploit, SQLMap, and Kali Linux.

IHIFIX DIGITAL TECHNOLOGIES **JULY 2023 – JANUARY 2024**

Software Developer (INTERN)

- Built and deployed 2 secure web applications using Node.js, Express, and Flask, all incorporating strong authentication and input validation practices.
- Identified and resolved over 15 security vulnerabilities during penetration testing, including high-risk SQLi flaws, using Burp Suite and manual techniques.
- Collaborated in a version-controlled team environment (Git/GitHub), contributing code to 2 major projects and maintaining clean CI/CD pipelines.
- Co-led planning and execution of Cybersecurity Awareness Month 2023, engaging 80+ participants through workshops and interactive sessions.

RESEARCH CONTRIBUTIONS

Published Journal Articles (8)

- **F. D Ifeanyi,** M. A Tariq, F. Adamu-Fika, V. E Eze, and E. M Dickson. (2025). "IoT Threat Detection Using Federated Learning and Edge AI with Random Forest Optimization". *Nature Journal of Emerging Sciences Technologies and Innovations, 3*(2), 92-103. **Link to paper**
- **F. D Ifeanyi,** O. A James, S. M Abdullahi, V. E Eze, and P. E Nze. (2026). "Enhanced Detection of Zero-Day Vulnerabilities in Network Traffic Using a Hybrid Random Forest and Convolutional Neural Network Model". *Nature Journal of Emerging Sciences Technologies and Innovations,* 4(3), 191-206. **Link to paper**
- P. E Nze, A. K Ademuwagun, M Bello, **F. D Ifeanyi,** S. M Abdullahi. (2026). "Large Language Model-Assisted Threat-Driven Testing System for Enhanced Cybersecurity Readiness". *Journal of Cyber Security*, *8(1)*, 469–486. **Link to paper**
- A. K Muhammed, **F. D Ifeanyi**, F. Adamu-Fika, O. E Olorunshola, and S. M Abdullahi. (2026). "Algorithmic Deception: A Comparative Entropy-Based Analysis of GenAI-Driven Phishing and Human Social Engineering". *NJESTI.,* 8(4), 377-390 **Link paper**
- M. C Komka, A. K Ademuwagun, S. M Abdullahi, T. M Mashkur, **F. D Ifeanyi** (2026). *"*Proactive Insider Threat Detection in Cloud Environments Using Behavior-Aware Machine Learning Models*". Nature Journal of Emerging Sciences Technologies and Innovations, 8*(4), 233-251. **Link to paper**
- A. K Muhammed, F. Adamu-Fika, **F. D Ifeanyi**. (2026). "Temporal Anomaly Detection API for Enhanced Deepfake Video Identification using ResNeXt-LSTM Approach". *Nature Journal of Emerging Sciences Technologies and Innovations, 5*(3), 233-251. **Link to paper**
- E. M Dickson, M Ibrahim, S. M Abdullahi, and **F. D Ifeanyi**. (2026). **"**Zero-Day Attack Detection Using a Hybrid Isolation Forest and XGBoost Model**".** *Nature Journal of Emerging Sciences Technologies and Innovations,* 4(3), 167-178. **Link to paper**
- Abooh K, Ademuwagun A. K, Shehu K. B, Abdullahi S. M, **Ifeanyi F. D**, (2026). "Implementation of Real-Time Data Anonymisation in Large Language Models Using Presidio." *Eurasian Journal of Science and Engineering, 12(1), 153-183.* **Link to paper**

Accepted for Publication (2)

- Lapips S. K, Ademuwagun A. K, Edmund A. N, **Ifeanyi F. D**, Abdullahi S. M, Muhammed A. K, (2026). Real-Time Phishing Email Detection System Using Random Forest and URL-Based Feature Engineering. International Journal of Research and Innovation in Applied Science**.**
- Boniface J, Ademuwagun A. K, Adedayo A. U, Abdullahi S. M, **Ifeanyi F. D**, (2026). "Blockchain-based Decentralized Authentication System for Secure Online Banking Applications". *NJESTI*.

Under Review (3)

- Tighil J, **Ifeanyi F. D**, Ademuwagun A. K, Abdullahi S. M, Adamu-Fika F, and Enem T., (2026). "Secure Username and Password Security Software Handler (SUPSSH): A Dynamic Symbol-Obfuscation Framework for Shoulder-Surfing and Injection-Resistant Credential Management." *Journal of Information Security and Applications.*
- Adeniran A. Y, Ademuwagun A. K, Adamu-Fika F., Abdullahi S. M, Bitrus F., and **Ifeanyi F. D,** (2026). "A User-Centric Context-Aware Permission Governance Framework for Privacy Control in Default Mobile Applications." *Scientific Journal of Computer Science.*
- Ogboada M. G, Ademuwagun A. K, Adamu-Fika F, Abdullahi S. M, **Ifeanyi F. D,** (2026). "Integrating Statistical Anomaly Detection and Differential Privacy in Federated Learning for Robust Defense against Data Poisoning." Paper under review in Journal of DICRSET.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS & ACCEPTED PAPERS

- **Ifeanyi, F. D.**, Abdullahi, S. M., Ogboada, M. G., Ademuwagun, A. K., Adamu-Fika, F., & Enem, T. A. *From Black Boxes to Knowledge Commons: A Governing Framework for AI Memory Transparency and Accountability.* **International Conference on Digital Innovation and Higher Education (ICDIHE 2026)**, University of Kigali, Rwanda, December 7–11, 2026. **Accepted for presentation.**
- **Ifeanyi, F. D.**, Abdullahi, S. M., Ogboada, M. G., Ademuwagun, A. K., Enem, T. A., & Adamu-Fika, F. *AI Governance for Automated Decision Systems in Developing Economies: A Context-Aware Framework for Nigeria and Africa.* **International Conference on AI across Disciplines**, Selçuk University, Türkiye, October 23-25, 2026. **Accepted for presentation.**

AWARDS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

✓	Award of Excellence for the Best Graduating Student (Male), Department of Cyber Security, AFIT	2024
✓	Awarded the Topmost Scholar in Cyber Security, AFIT	2024
✓	Department of Cyber Security award of special recognition for Exceptional Service to the Class	2024
✓	Award of Excellence for Outstanding Communication, Publicity, and Service (NYSC, AFIT)	2025

RESEARCH INTEREST

- **Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning:** Machine learning, deep learning, representation learning, intelligent systems, and data-driven approaches to complex real-world problems.
- **Natural Language Processing and Large Language Models:** NLP, LLMs, generative AI, AI agents, language-based reasoning, and trustworthy AI systems.
- **AI for Cybersecurity and Trustworthy AI:** AI-driven threat detection, behavioural modelling, adversarial machine learning, privacy-preserving AI, explainable AI, and secure intelligent systems.
- **Intelligent Systems and Emerging AI Applications:** AI for IoT and connected systems, federated learning, edge AI, and scalable intelligent solutions for real-world applications.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI/ML: TensorFlow, PyTorch, Scikit-learn, NumPy, Pandas, SciPy, OpenCV, BERT
Cybersecurity: Network Security, Intrusion Detection, Threat Detection, Web Application Security, Vulnerability Assessment, Burp Suite, Nmap, Metasploit, SQLMap, Wireshark, Kali Linux
AI Security & Emerging Technologies: Federated Learning, Edge AI, Large Language Models, Privacy-Preserving AI
Programming & Data: Python, JavaScript, SQL, MATLAB
Web & Systems: Node.js, React, Flask, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Linux, Git/GitHub, Active Directory

CERTIFICATES / CERTIFICATIONS

Aspire Institute 2026 Aspire Leaders Program	2026
Certified AppSec Practitioner (CAP) with merit, The SecOps Group	2025
Cisco Ethical Hacker (Cisco Networking Academy)	2024
Penetration Testing, Incident Response and Forensics (IBM, Coursera)	2024
Advanced Python Reconnaissance (Infosec, Coursera)	2024
Linux and SQL (Google, Coursera)	2023
Foundations of Cybersecurity (Google, Coursera)	2023

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Deputy Class President, Cyber Security Department **2021 - 2024**

I served as a deputy to the class president, assisting as an intermediary between students and the faculty/departmental management on student and academic related issues such as the organization of academic field trips, seminars, and submission of class attendance and reports/assignments.

Team Leader (Interns), IHIFIX Digital Technologies **2023 - 2024**

During my internship at IHIFIX Digital Academy, I served as the team leader and managed teams to ensure the timely and smooth communication of tasks, coordinated team efforts, and ensured that we developed projects and reported back before deadlines. My leadership ensured that the team consistently met assessments and deliverables on time.

VOLUNTEER ACTIVITIES/COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENTS

STUDENT TUTOR – CYBERSECURITY DEPARTMENT **2021 – 2024**

- Voluntarily tutored students across various levels (Year 1 – 4) in technical courses.
- Courses included: Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Cryptographic Techniques, Software defined Networking, Systems Analysis, Algorithm and Complexity Analysis, Data Structures, and Discrete Structure.
- Helped peers improve academic performance and practical understanding of technical concepts by facilitating group revision sessions and examination preparation activities.

CYBER SECURITY AWARENESS OUTREACH –
GOVERNMENT SECONDARY SCHOOL, RIGACHIKUN *Speaker* **|15TH JULY 2023**

- Collaborated with a team to organize a cybersecurity outreach program that impacted over 120 secondary school students in Kaduna State.
- Delivered a compelling session on phishing attacks, educating students on real-world tactics, warning signs and preventive measures.
- Successfully raised awareness of cyberbullying, cyberstalking, and online safety, leading to increased student engagement, and over 30 students expressed interest in pursuing a cybersecurity career.
- Distributed official safety hotlines and reporting channels, equipping students with practical tools for online protection.

"SECURE YOUR WORLD" CYBER SECURITY WORKSHOP - IHIFIX *Featured Speaker* **|2ND OCTOBER 2023**

- Co-led a 5-person planning team that organized a workshop attended by 80+ participants in celebration of Cybersecurity Awareness Month.
- Delivered an engaging talk on "Navigating the Social Media Maze and Deciphering URLs", receiving positive feedback from both technical and non-technical attendees and provided actionable strategies for safe online behavior.